

DESIGN BEYOND CODE

Build a personal website with Codex, shape it with references, and publish it with GitHub Pages.

CV + References + Design Language + Brief	Codex	Website	Critique	Revise	Publish
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Today's challenge

Build and publish a one-page site that feels specific to you, not like a generic AI-generated portfolio. There is deliberately **no starter HTML/CSS template**. Codex generates each site from scratch using your CV, references and design brief.

Core rule: Codex can write your code. You still need to own your code.

1. Create your GitHub repository

Create a **public** repository named `YOUR-USERNAME.github.io`.

2. Open it in VS Code

On GitHub: **Code** -> **HTTPS** -> **Copy URL**.

In VS Code: **Clone Git Repository** -> **paste URL** -> **choose a folder** -> **Open**.

3. Copy in the student kit

Copy the supplied files/folders into the cloned repository. You should see `DESIGN.md`, `CODEX_PROMPTS.md`, `skeletons/`, `references/`, `private-inputs/`, and `assets/`.

There should still be **no index.html or style.css yet**.

4. Add your CV and project material

Put your CV locally in `private-inputs/CV.pdf`. This folder is ignored by Git so the CV is not published by accident.

Put website/project images in `assets/`. Attach the CV to Codex if needed.

5. Choose a design language

Open skeletons/ and choose one primary direction: **Editorial**, **Architecture** / **Minimal**, **Technical** / **Research**, or **Experimental**. Read its DESIGN_LANGUAGE.md and open its LAYOUT_SKETCH.svg. These are design principles, not templates.

6. Complete DESIGN.md

Add the purpose of your site, three personality words, your chosen design language, what from your CV should be emphasized, and your preferred typography/layout.

Add your own references

Paste links or screenshots of websites/designs you like. For each reference, explain **what specifically you want to follow** and what you do not want copied.

- Good: "I like the oversized typography and wide margins."
- Good: "I want to follow the image-led project layout, but not the colour palette."
- Avoid: "I like the vibe."

Find at least one reference yourself. The supplied reference library is only a starting point.

Important: "Codex Step 1", "Step 2", etc. are simply the stages of this exercise. They are **not buttons or modes** in Codex. Open CODEX_PROMPTS.md and copy/paste the prompt for the current step into Codex.

7. Codex Step 1 - PLAN

Open CODEX_PROMPTS.md and copy/paste the prompt under **CODEX STEP 1 - PLAN** into Codex.

Codex should first interpret:

- your CV/content;
- your references;
- your design language;
- the information and visual hierarchy;
- the proposed page structure;
- one distinctive design move.

Do not let it code yet. Read the proposed design plan and correct it until it sounds like the site you actually want.

8. Codex Step 2 - BUILD

Copy/paste **CODEX STEP 2 - BUILD**. Codex should create the site from scratch using simple static files:

```
index.html
style.css
script.js # only if useful
assets/
```

Avoid unnecessary frameworks or build systems. The site should work as a static GitHub Pages site.

9. Codex Step 3 - CRITIQUE & REVISE

Look at the first result. Before asking Codex to improve it, identify:

- 3 things that look generic or AI-generated;
- 3 things that successfully reflect your references;
- 1 hierarchy, spacing, typography, or composition problem.

Then copy/paste **CODEX STEP 3 - CRITIQUE & REVISE**. Codex should revise the existing site rather than rebuilding everything.

10. Codex Step 4 - UNDERSTAND & EDIT

Copy/paste **CODEX STEP 4 - UNDERSTAND & EDIT**. Codex will explain where the important HTML/CSS lives and suggest a safe visible modification.

Then use VS Code to personally change at least one visible part of the site, for example:

- heading size;
- spacing;
- colour;
- image width;
- grid layout;
- section order;
- hover behaviour.

You do not need to write the whole website yourself, but you should know roughly where the design lives in the code.

11. Run the anti-slop check

Open `AI_SLOP_CHECKLIST.md`. The most important question is:

Could I swap my name and project images with another person's and nobody would notice?

If yes, revise the design.

12. Publish

Commit and push your files to GitHub. Then on GitHub go to: **Settings -> Pages -> Deploy from a branch -> main**.

Your site should publish at:

`https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io`

Publishing may take a few minutes.

Overall workflow

CV + References + Design Language + Design Brief -> Codex -> Code -> Preview -> Critique -> Revise -> Manual Edit -> Publish